Royal Insignia

Sceptre *(kŌl)*, drum (*murasu*) and white umbrella (*venkudai*) were used as the symbols of royal authority.

Muvendar	Garland	Port	Capital	Symbols
Cheras	Palmyra flower	Muziri / Tondi	Vanchi / Karur	 Bow and arrow
Cholas	Fig (Athi) lower	Puhar	Uraiyur / Puhar	 Tiger
Pandyas	Margosa (neem) flower	Korkai	Madurai	 Two Fish

Minor Chieftains – Ay, Velir and Kizhar

Apart from three great kings, there were several brave independent minor chieftains. The name 'Ay' is derived from the ancient Tamil word 'Ayar' (meaning shepherd). Among Ay chiefs of Sangam Age, Anthiran, Titiran and Nannan were the important names.



The Velirs–Vellalars– constituted the ruling and land-owning class in the ancient Tamizhagam. The famous Velirs were the seven patrons (*KadaiyezhuVallalgal*). They were Pari, Kari, Ori, Pegan, Ay, Adiyaman and Nalli. They were popular for their generous patronage of Tamil poets.

Kizhar was the village chief.

Sangam Polity

Kingship

The kingship was hereditary. The king was called *k*Ō. It is the shortened form of *Kon*. *Vendan, Kon, Mannan, Kotravan* and *Iraivan* were the other titles by which the king was addressed. The eldest son of the reigning king generally succeeded to the throne. The coronation ceremony was known as *arasukattilerudhal* or *mudisoottuvila*. The crown prince was known as *komahan*, while the young ones were known as *Ilango, Ilanchezhiyan* and

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